

IT'S 2026! WILL GTA VI FINALLY RELEASE?

Initially slated for a late November 2025 launch, the date was **postponed** to November 19, 2026

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Grand Theft Auto (GTA) has been one of the best-selling franchises of Rockstar Games. Having started in 1997, the franchise has shipped over 450 million copies. And with every release, expectations have risen among fans. However, the last full release of the game, GTA V, came out over a decade ago, in 2013. The anticipation over GTA VI has grown from hope to desperation among fans. But the release has not arrived yet.

Initially slated for a late November 2025 launch, the date was postponed to November 19, 2026. And now, Mike York, a former developer of GTA, feels any further delay would damage the game's support and reputation.

Speaking to *Esports Insider*, York said, "If Rockstar Games delays GTA 6 again, then the hype around the game will die down almost completely. Right now, nobody is searching for GTA 6. Everyone knows there's no news, there's nothing to talk about... There's a point to where you delay something so much that you start to make people angry."

He also shed light on how much the game could actually cost. "I don't think the price tag for GTA 6 will be USD 100. I think it will come out (priced) at USD 70, around the flatline of normal releases," York said.

"I don't think Rockstar Games feels they need to release it at a higher cost. They'll sell so many copies of the game that they won't need to be greedy and charge USD 100."

The GTA VI year, 2026, is here. But will the wait finally end?

CO-CREATOR OF CALL OF DUTY PASSES AWAY

Vince Zampella, co-creator of the Call of Duty franchise and founder of Respawn Entertainment, passed away aged 55, following a horrific road accident. A report by NBC4 stated that Zampella was among the two people in the vehicle that collided with a barrier while driving out of a tunnel in Los Angeles' San Gabriel Mountains.

Zampella is regarded as a legend in the first-person shooter genre. He was instrumental in the development of Call of Duty 4: Modern Warfare and 2009's Call of Duty: Modern Warfare 2.

"We're heartbroken by the passing of our founder and dear friend Vince Zampella," Respawn Entertainment wrote on social media.

"Vince was a titan and legend of this industry, a visionary leader and a force who shaped teams and games like Call of Duty, Titanfall, Apex Legends, the Star Wars Jedi series and Battlefield for our community in ways that will be felt for generations."

SOUTH KOREA THE NEXT DESTINATION FOR OLYMPIC ESPORTS GAMES?

After negotiations collapsed between the International Olympic Committee (IOC) and Saudi Arabia regarding the hosting of the Olympic Esports Games (OEGs), South Korea has expressed interest in becoming the host.

The proposal was discussed during a parliamentary forum in Seoul on December 22, but further details on the issue are awaited.